

FAQs

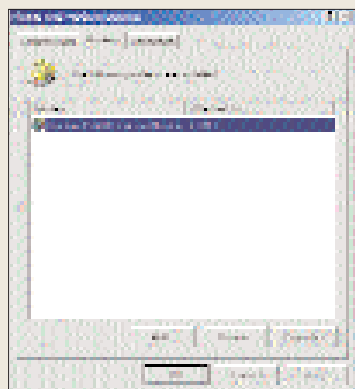
Initialising the modem in Windows 2000

Q. My PC has a Pentium III 933 MHz processor, 256 MB RAM, and a 48.5 GB hard disk. I have Windows 2000 installed. I have a 33.6 bps external modem. I want to know how to initialise my modem when Windows 2000 is already loaded. If I forget to put it on, I have to restart my computer to get my modem to work again.

Paras Barot

Via e-mail

A Unlike Windows 98/Me, even though your modem is installed you will have to switch it on when Windows 2000 loads, else you will have to go through the process of restarting the machine. However, there is a solution wherein you can fool Windows. Go to **Control Panel > Phone and Modem**



Initialise modem in Windows 2000 without restarting your machine

Options. Click on **Modem > Add.** It will prompt you to add a modem. Click on 'Next'. Since your modem is switched off, Windows won't be able to detect a new modem and will automatically accept your previous modem as currently installed. Now without rebooting your machine you can make Windows 2000 detect your modem and connect to the Internet.

Creating PDF files

Q. I installed Adobe Acrobat 5, but I am unable to create any PDF documents. How can I create PDF files?

Sudhir

Via e-mail

A What you are referring to is Adobe Acrobat Reader. This application only allows you to read PDF files. To create PDF files you will need Adobe Acrobat PDF writer. This is available for around Rs 12,500. As an alternative, Adobe also provides a service where you can create PDF files online, for which you can choose a monthly or yearly subscription. More details are available on Adobe's Web site www.adobe.com.

However, when I unplugged it and connected it to serial port1 it was detected and worked fine. Then I plugged in the mouse to serial port2, but my system failed to detect it. Is my motherboard defective?

Subash

Via e-mail

A To solve your problem, first go to your BIOS (press

[Del] when you get the Power On Self Test (POST) screen during bootup) and check whether your serial port is disabled. It probably is disabled, and as a result any device attached to it does not get detected. In case it is not disabled then you should contact your hardware vendor and ask him to send the

motherboard to the RMA centre for thorough testing.

What is STR?

Q. I recently purchased a new motherboard on which was clearly mentioned 'STR'. I would like to know what it actually means and whether it improves the performance of the motherboard.

Sushma

Via e-mail

A Suspend-to-RAM (STR) allows your system to enter a low-power state. To enable it, go to the BIOS (press [Del] when you get the Power On Self Test (POST) screen during bootup), and under 'Power Management' enable the Suspend-to-RAM option.

Once it is enabled, information on system configuration, open applications, and active files are stored in the main memory (RAM), while most of the system's other components are turned off.

A system in STR can use as little as 5 watts of power, with most of it going to the main memory for data maintenance. When left in this state, a system may be programmed to waken, so it can perform tasks at any given time.

If the power is interrupted, then the system will undergo a normal reboot, restoring full power to the machine and any information not saved to the hard disk will be lost.

Drained motherboard battery

Q. I have a Pentium III 550 MHz PC, which is around one-and-a-half years old. While booting my PC, I receive this message: 'Please check CPU speed and press any key to continue.' After

pressing a key it goes into setup mode. I quit without saving and it goes back to normal. The time clock also runs slow and shows the wrong time and date, in spite of the fact that I set it right every now and then. Please help.

Mukesh C. Bhatt

Via e-mail

A In order to solve your problem all you need to do is change your motherboard battery.

System performance below par

Q. I have recently purchased an Athlon 1800+ system. However, I find that the performance of this PC does not match your results (mentioned in the January 2002 issue).

Furthermore, games crash or give an extremely unplayable frame rate. The processor temperature is absolutely normal as my machine is rock stable. What could be the problem?

Garry

Via e-mail

A Your system does not generate the scores as per our test because you haven't installed the latest VIA four-in-one drivers.

These drivers contain updates, which include four system drivers, to improve performance and maintain the stability of systems using VIA chipsets.

These four drivers are: VIA Registry (INF) driver, VIA AGP VxD driver, VIA ATAPI Vendor Support driver and VIA PCI IRQ Miniport driver. After installing this set of drivers your system should give you optimum performance.



Send your problems to sos@jasubhai.com or write to Digit, D-222/2, Om Sagar, MIDC, Nerul-400 706